

Gascovid Double Action Chewable Tablets

VIGAS06-var2

Description

Round, 16 mm, pinkish, mottled uncoated tablet with peppermint flavour, bevel-edged and flat faces.

Composition

Each tablet contains Sodium Alginate 250 mg, Sodium Bicarbonate 106.5 mg and Calcium Carbonate 187.5 mg.

Actions and Pharmacology

The medicinal product is a combination of two antacids (calcium carbonate and sodium bicarbonate) and an alginate. On ingestion, the medicinal product reacts rapidly with gastric acid to form a raft of alginic acid gel having a near neutral pH and which floats on the stomach contents effectively impeding gastro-oesophageal reflux. In severe cases the raft itself may be refluxed into the oesophagus, in preference to the stomach contents, and exert a demulcent effect.

Calcium carbonate neutralises gastric acid to provide fast relief from indigestion and heartburn. This effect is increased by the addition of sodium bicarbonate which also has a neutralising action. The total neutralising capacity of the product at the lowest dose of two tablets is approximately 10 mEqH+.

Pharmacokinetics

The mode of action of the medicinal product is physical and does not depend on absorption into the systemic circulation.

Indications

Treatment of acid related symptoms of gastro-oesophageal reflux such as acid regurgitation, heartburn and indigestion, for example following meals or during pregnancy.

Contraindications

This medicinal product is contraindicated in patients with known or suspected hypersensitivity to the active substances or to any of the excipients.

Pregnancy and Lactation

Studies did not show any significant adverse effects of Gascovid Double Action Chewable Tablets on the course of pregnancy or on the health of the foetus/new-born child. Based on this and previous experience, the medicinal product may be used during pregnancy and lactation. Nevertheless, taking into account the presence of calcium carbonate it is recommended to limit the treatment duration as much as possible.

Precautions

This product contains sodium. This should be taken into account when a highly restricted salt diet is recommended, e.g. in some cases of congestive cardiac failure and renal impairment.

This product contains calcium carbonate. Care needs to be taken in treating patients with hypercalcaemia, nephrocalcinosis and recurrent calcium containing renal calculi.

There is a possibility of reduced efficacy in patients with very low levels of gastric acid.

If symptoms do not improve after seven days, the clinical situation should be reviewed.

Treatment of children younger than 12 years of age is not generally recommended, except on medical advice.

Interaction with Other Medicaments and Other Forms of Interaction

Due to the presence of calcium carbonate which act as an antacid, a time-interval of 2 hours should be considered between Gascovid Double Action Chewable Tablets intake and the administration of other medicinal products, especially H2-antihistaminics tetracyclines, digoxine, fluoroquinolone, iron salt, ketoconazole, neuroleptics, thyroxine, penicilamine, beta-blockers (atenolol, metoprolol, propranolol), glucocorticoid, chloroquine, and diphosphonates.

Main Side/Adverse Effects

Very rarely (<1/10,000) patients may develop allergic manifestations such as urticaria or bronchospasm, anaphylactic or anaphylactoid reactions.

Overdose

In the event of overdosage symptomatic treatment should be given. The patient may notice abdominal distension.

Dosage and Administration

For oral administration, after being thoroughly chewed.

Adults and children 12 years and over: Two to four tablets after meals and at bedtime, up to four times per day.

Children under 12 years: Should be given only on medical advice.

Elderly: No dose modifications necessary for this age group.

Note: The information given here is limited. For further information consult your doctor or pharmacists.

Storage : Store below 30°C.

Presentation/ packing : Blister of 1x6's, 2x6's, 10x6's.

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